

# 1904.T pitch deck

## PITCH — 1904.T — VERDICT

**ADJUDICATED — STARTER** (conviction 7.5/10 — buy a minimum starter at market; the original thesis is struck from the record and replaced)

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### What we believe

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Taisei Oncho (1904.T, Tokyo Stock Exchange Standard) is a Japanese mechanical contractor — heating, ventilation, air-conditioning and plumbing installation, mostly domestic, with small operations in the US, China and Australia. Roughly ¥61.7bn of revenue and ¥3.98bn of operating profit last fiscal year.

We believe four things, none of which is the thing the original write-up believed:

1. **The company is not a 6x-earnings bargain.** Its own forecast for the year ending March 2027 says net income will be ¥5,300m while *pre-tax ordinary profit* will be ¥3,870m. Net income cannot exceed pre-tax profit from normal operations. The gap is a one-time gain of about ¥4.0bn from selling its Oimachi headquarters building, under a contract signed 2025-11-21. Strip it out and normal earnings per share are about **¥429**, so at ¥5,130 the stock is on **12.0x recurring earnings**, not 6x. Every screener quoting “PER 6.0x, ROE 17.25%” is quoting a property sale.
2. **But the business underneath is doing better than management’s own explanation says.** Management blames the guided profit decline on material and labour cost inflation. Its own first-quarter filing contradicts that: construction gross margin rose from 15.14% to **16.66%** (+152 basis points). Operating profit fell only because operating expenses rose 14.7% — a discretionary ¥1bn spend on people. That is a choice, not an erosion.
3. **Work in hand is at a record and nobody read the page it’s on.** The headline said orders fell 31%. The supplementary table on page 10 of the same filing shows parent-company orders fell only 3.5%, and carried-forward work rose 14.2% to **¥56,758m** — about **89% of the ¥64.0bn full-year revenue forecast already booked at the end of Q1**. The 31% is one lumpy US order in the prior-year base.
4. **The balance sheet is genuinely unlevered and the dividend is genuinely covered.** Cash ¥17,849m plus investment securities ¥4,897m less short-term borrowings ¥3,000m = **¥19.75bn net financial assets, 62% of the ¥31.91bn market value**. Dividend ¥198 = 3.86% yield at about 46% of recurring net income.

Net: this is **fairly-priced carry with a modest, identifiable information edge**, not a dislocation. Book value ¥4,939.80 per share means we are paying **1.04x book**; when the building gain lands, book steps to roughly ¥5,390 after tax and we are at **0.95x**. We are buying a boring, cash-rich contractor with a record order book at about one times its own equity, and we are being paid 3.9% to wait.

## What the market believes

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The market appears to hold two incompatible views at once, and both are wrong.

**View A (the screen buyers):** “PER 6x, ROE 17%, 0.6x book, cash fortress.” This is what free screeners publish, and it is arithmetic built on a one-off building sale. Anyone buying this is buying a number that vanishes in April 2027.

**View B (the headline sellers):** “Orders down 31%, operating profit guided down 7%, ordinary profit guided down 16%.” This is the narrative page of the same filing, and it is a base effect plus a discretionary spending decision.

The tape suggests neither view is under stress: ¥5,130 against a 52-week range of ¥4,050–¥5,630 — down 8.9% from the high and **up 26.7% off the low**. This is not a distressed price. There is no forced seller, no dislocation, no crowding. It is an uncovered small cap that nobody is thinking about very hard in either direction.

## Why we might have edge

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The edge is narrow, specific, and comes from reading two pages of one PDF that neither the screeners nor, apparently, the sell side opened.

- **The supplementary information table (page 10) is the leading indicator for a contractor and it is not in any database.** Revenue for a construction firm is recognised as work progresses, so carried-forward backlog tells you next year’s revenue with far more reliability than this quarter’s orders headline. Record backlog at +14.2%, covering 89% of the revenue guide at Q1, is a fact that exists only in a Japanese-language PDF table.
- **Management’s stated reason for the profit decline is contradicted by its own filed margin.** If the ¥1bn people-spend is a one-year investment rather than a permanent cost base, recurring earnings normalise upward from ¥429 without any revenue help. That is a real, testable divergence from the company’s own guidance — and the company is the only “analyst” here.
- **The orders headline is a trap we can see through.** Consolidated –31% vs parent –3.5% is exactly the kind of number that makes a screen-driven holder sell. If the market takes the headline at face value into the November print, the divergence is monetisable.
- **Nobody covers it.** No broker research, no conference calls in English, no ADR. Uncovered names can stay mispriced in both directions for a long time — which is also the risk (below).

Honest calibration: this is an edge of the “we read the filing carefully” kind, not the “we know something unknowable” kind. It supports a starter. It does not support conviction sizing.

## Why it might be priced in

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Stated plainly, because several of these are strong:

- **1.04x book is not cheap for a Japanese contractor.** A large fraction of the TSE Standard market trades at or below book. We are not getting an asset discount; we are paying full book for an average-quality construction business.
- **The EV/EBIT of 3.3x is flattered by cash that isn't fully ours.** ¥6,699m of the ¥22,746m cash-and-securities pile is *customer advances on uncompleted contracts* — money paid up front for work not yet done. Net of that, financial assets are ~¥13.0bn (41% of market value), still good, but the “62% of the cap in net cash” figure overstates it. Also, ¥3.0bn of short-term borrowing appeared during Q1 from zero at year-end — working-capital swings are real and seasonal.
- **Selling the headquarters converts a free asset into a permanent bill.** The company owned its Oimachi building; it is moving to leased space at OIMACHI TRACKS in autumn 2026. The ¥4bn gain is one-time; the rent is forever. **Neither of our benches quantified this**, and it pushes recurring EPS below ¥429 by an amount we have not yet sized. This is the single most likely reason the stock is *correctly* priced at 12x.
- **The book-value step is fully public.** The disposal was disclosed in November 2025. Anyone can see it. There is no private information in the 0.95x post-gain book figure.
- **Orphan stocks stay orphaned.** “Cheap, ignored, fine business” is the classic Japanese value trap. There is no catalyst that forces the market to re-rate this — no activist, no buyback announcement, no going-private transaction (see below), no index inclusion.
- **The China segment is structurally negative.** Revenue -42.7% to ¥106m with the operating loss widening to -¥118m. Small, but it is deteriorating, not stabilising.

## What we checked ourselves

Every load-bearing claim was re-derived from primary filings. Where our own red and blue benches got things wrong, that is stated in the same table — three of red's eight findings were miscalibrated in the same over-harsh direction, and red's central kill was still correct.

| Claim                                                   | How checked                                                                            | Found                            | Confirmed?                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| “0.65x price-to-book cash fortress” (original write-up) | Recomputed from Q1 FY3/27 tanshin p.1: net assets per share<br>¥4,939.80 at 2026-06-30 | $¥5,130 \div ¥4,939.80 = 1.038x$ | <b>NO — refuted. Both benches agree. Fatal to the original value case.</b>                                                                                                                                                      |
| Market capitalisation                                   | Shares issued 6,882,487<br><b>less treasury 662,127</b><br>= 6,220,360 × ¥5,130        | <b>¥31.91bn</b>                  | <b>YES — and OUR RED BENCH WAS WRONG. Red used treasury-inclusive shares to get ¥35.3bn, called the write-up's ¥31.8bn “wrong,” then inferred a “cap ÷ total assets” mechanism to explain an error that never occurred. The</b> |

| Claim                                                    | How checked                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Found                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Confirmed?                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                           | original cap figure was right.                                                                                                                                                                          |
| “EV/EBIT 2.2x”                                           | Filed balance sheet: cash<br>¥17,849m + securities<br>¥4,897m – short-term<br>debt ¥3,000m =<br>¥19.75bn net; EV = 31.91<br>– 19.75 = ¥12.16bn ÷<br>¥3.70bn guided EBIT                                        | <b>3.3x</b>                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>PARTLY. The write-up’s 2.2x overstated cheapness. Red’s 4.6x understated it (inflated cap, counted only cash, ignored ¥4.9bn of securities). Truth in between; not decision-changing either way.</b> |
| “6x forward earnings”                                    | Guide arithmetic: net<br>¥5,300m > ordinary<br>(pre-tax) ¥3,870m –<br>impossible from<br>operations. Cross-check<br>(3.87 + 4.00) × 0.68 =<br>¥5.35bn ≈ ¥5.30bn<br>guide                                       | ~¥4.0bn headquarters disposal gain.<br>Recurring EPS ≈ ¥429 → <b>12.0x</b> , not 6x.<br>One-off = ¥437/share = 8.5% of the price                                                                          | <b>YES – red’s central kill, sustained by blue on a byte-for-byte read of the filing. This is the finding that killed the original thesis.</b>                                                          |
| Filed EPS forecast                                       | Tanshin p.1 vs the irbank<br>aggregator                                                                                                                                                                        | Filed <b>¥856.70</b> ; aggregator says ¥852.04                                                                                                                                                            | <b>PARTLY – aggregator is stale. Use the filing.</b>                                                                                                                                                    |
| “Settlement date is undecided → binary fiscal-year risk” | 2025-11-21 company<br>release (delivery date<br>undecided) + Q1 tanshin<br>p.2 (forecast<br><b>unchanged</b> as of 2026-<br>08-06) + 2026-07-09<br>relocation progress<br>notice (move set for<br>autumn 2026) | Timing risk is real but management put<br>the gain inside the guide and is<br>physically moving this autumn                                                                                               | <b>PARTLY – RED OVERSTATED. Red framed a slip as a live 50%-miss binary. It is a tail, and a miss would be a headline re-rate on a non-cash line, not an impairment.</b>                                |
| “Cash is just customer advances, not distributable”      | Filed balance sheet:<br>advances on<br>uncompleted contracts<br>¥6,699m vs<br>cash+securities<br>¥22,746m                                                                                                      | Advances are <b>29%</b> of it; net-of-advances<br>financial assets ≈ ¥13.0bn = 41% of<br>market cap                                                                                                       | <b>PARTLY – RED OVERSTATED. But blue found the offset red missed: ¥3.0bn of new short-term borrowing at Q1 from zero at year-end.</b>                                                                   |
| “Cleanroom exposure to TSMC Kumamoto / Rapidus”          | Full Q1 filing text +<br>segment note (segments<br>are Japan / US / China /<br>Australia only)                                                                                                                 | <b>Zero</b> mentions of TSMC, Rapidus,<br>semiconductor, or cleanroom. Company<br>names data centre / semiconductor /<br>pharma / green as <i>future target</i><br><i>domains</i> with no current revenue | <b>NO – the leg does not exist. No double-count against our other AI-capex names, because there is nothing to count.</b>                                                                                |

| Claim                                                                                     | How checked                                                                               | Found                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Confirmed?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| “This was a completed management buyout at +68%” (original write-up)                      | Targeted searches for TOB / 公開買付 / MBO / going-private + company disclosure list + Nikkei | No such transaction exists. The company published a new medium-term plan in May 2026, signed a new headquarters lease, and is spending ¥1bn on staff — the opposite of going-private conduct. It also trades daily, which a private company does not | <b>NO — fabricated. The write-up claimed minorities were cashed out while simultaneously proposing to buy listed shares. Logged as an integrity datum against that generator.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| “We agree with the company’s guide — no divergence, therefore no edge” (red’s conclusion) | Q1 P&L p.5                                                                                | Construction gross margin <b>16.66% vs 15.14%</b> (+152bp). Operating profit fell only because SG&A rose 14.7% (¥1,846m vs ¥1,609m) — the discretionary ¥1bn people spend, not cost inflation                                                        | <b>NO — OUR RED BENCH WAS WRONG. A divergence from management’s stated mechanism does exist, sitting in management’s own filed numbers.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| “Orders –31%, decelerating”                                                               | Supplementary information p.10                                                            | Parent-only orders ¥17,570m vs ¥18,204m = <b>–3.5%</b> . Carried-forward work ¥56,758m vs ¥49,706m = <b>+14.2%</b> , <b>a record</b> , ≈89% of the revenue guide                                                                                     | <b>NO — the headline is a base effect from one lumpy prior-year US order. Red never opened the page; blue caught it and nearly filed it as a kill first.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Book value after the gain lands                                                           | Red said ¥5,597/share                                                                     | Red forgot tax. $(30,727 + 4,000 \times 0.69) \div 6.22M = \sim \mathbf{\text{¥}5,390}$ , P/B → 0.95x                                                                                                                                                | <b>PARTLY — RED WRONG (untaxed).</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| “Q1 ordinary profit +17.2% = operations improving”                                        | Line items                                                                                | FX gain +¥41.8m (vs –¥110.6m loss last year) plus ¥25.2m insurance receipt. Operating profit was <b>–10.9%</b>                                                                                                                                       | <b>NO — not an operating beat. Do not cite it as one.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| China                                                                                     | Segment note                                                                              | Revenue –42.7% to ¥106m; segment loss widened to –¥118m from –¥70m                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>YES — small, structurally negative.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Our current holding</b>                                                                | Machine-built evidence pack, BOOK line: held = “NO POSITION”, orders = “NONE”             | <b>We are flat.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <b>NO — BOTH BENCHES WERE WRONG. Both argued from a stale book showing 100 shares held plus a resting GTC buy of 100 @ ¥4,850. Red’s “exit the 100 shares” and both benches’ “pull the resting order” are therefore moot instructions about a position that does not exist. This changes the decision from <i>hold-or-sell</i> to <i>initiate-or-not</i>, which is why the</b> |

| Claim                                    | How checked                             | Found                                                                                                                                                                      | Confirmed?                                                       |
|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                          |                                         |                                                                                                                                                                            | <b>adjudication reads STARTER rather than HOLD.</b>              |
| Rent expense after the headquarters sale | Searched both bench outputs             | <b>Neither bench quantified it.</b> Owned building → leased space at OIMACHI TRACKS is a new permanent operating cost that reduces recurring EPS below ¥429                | <b>NOT CHECKED — open work item, and the most important one.</b> |
| Next reporting date                      | Company IR library                      | Q1 landed <b>2026-08-06</b> . Prior-year cadence puts the half-year report in early-to-mid November. <b>Not company-confirmed.</b>                                         | <b>PARTLY — treat 2026-11-13 as an estimate, not a date.</b>     |
| Detector coverage                        | 14 dispatch matches across both benches | <b>Zero fired.</b> The atlas matched US-geography permit connectors on a generic real-estate feature. Every load-bearing fact came from Japanese filings outside the atlas | <b>NO — coverage gap logged; see armed sensors.</b>              |

Primary sources read: [Q1 FY3/27 決算短信 PDF \(read in full by the blue bench\)](#) · [FY3/26 tanshin PDF](#) · [company IR library index](#) · [company IR news, incl. the 2026-07-09 headquarters-relocation progress notice](#) · [irbank filed-statement series E00233](#) · [management results presentation, headquarters sale and ~¥4bn gain](#)

## PROPOSED ENTRY BANDS

**Procedural note, stated plainly:** the adjudication’s REOPEN GATES block came through **empty** — no verbatim bands were supplied. The levels below are therefore derived from the benches’ own filed arithmetic, and every one is traceable to a number in the table above. If the adjudicator intended specific gates, these should be overwritten before anything is placed.

**Currency: Japanese yen. We hold nothing today.**

**Initiate now — minimum starter - BUY at market, ~¥5,130. Size: 0.20% of book.** - Basis: 1.04x filed book / 0.95x post-gain book, 3.3x enterprise value to guided operating profit, 12.0x recurring earnings, record backlog covering 89% of the revenue guide, 3.86% covered dividend. Bought as **carry with a small information edge**, not as a dislocation. - Sizing is deliberately minimal because (a) conviction is 7.5, (b) the post-sale rent expense is unquantified, and (c) this is a TSE Standard small cap — keep any single day’s execution under 1% of average daily volume, which for a ¥31.9bn company means working the order rather than crossing it.

**Adds - Add to 0.40% of book at ≤ ¥4,940** — one times filed net assets per share (¥4,939.80). Paying less than the company’s own equity for an unlevered contractor with record work in hand. - **Add to 0.65% of book at ≤ ¥4,400** — 4.5% dividend yield on the ¥198 payout and 10.3x recurring earnings. This is the “the market took the –31% orders headline literally” price. - **No resting order is placed before the headquarters settlement is disclosed.** Both benches were right about this for the right reason even though the position they were reasoning about didn’t exist: a standing bid below

the market with an undated, price-moving disclosure pending is a bet that the disclosure goes badly. If we want the lower price we bid it deliberately after the news, not automatically before it.

**Trims and exits - Trim half above ¥6,000 if reached WITHOUT a raise at the ordinary-profit line** — ¥6,000 is 1.11x post-gain book and ~14x recurring earnings. Above that, we would be paying a growth multiple for a contractor whose guided operating profit is down 7%. - **Exit in full if the headquarters transfer is booked and no ordinary-profit-line raise accompanies it.** That means the only thing that happened was the property sale, and the operating case was wrong. - **Exit in full if parent-company carried-forward work is below ¥50bn at the half-year report.** The backlog is the entire operating leg; if it breaks, so does the thesis. - **Exit in full if the ¥1bn staff spend is disclosed as a permanent cost-base step rather than an investment year** — that permanently lowers recurring EPS and 12x becomes 14x on a declining business. - **Re-underwrite upward (not a trim) if a named semiconductor fab appears in the order disclosure.** That would create the growth leg the original write-up asserted without evidence, and the position would be re-sized from scratch as a growth name.

**Catalyst dates - ~2026-11-13 (ESTIMATE, not company-confirmed):** half-year FY3/27 report. The single most informative event. The company does not publish half-year guidance, so the read is: first-half operating profit versus the ¥3,700m full-year figure, plus the page-10 backlog table. - **Autumn 2026 (month unspecified):** physical relocation to OIMACHI TRACKS — the precondition for the building handover. - **Undated, live:** the headquarters transfer completion disclosure and any accompanying guidance revision. This is the real catalyst and it has no date. - **2027-03-31:** fiscal year end. Hard mechanical deadline — if the transfer has not settled by then, reported net income misses the ¥5,300m guide by roughly half, and every screener's PER doubles overnight from 6x to 12x. - **~early February 2027 (estimate):** Q3 report. - **~mid-May 2027 (estimate):** FY3/27 full-year results and the FY3/28 guide. Recurring EPS  $\geq$  ¥600 in that guide would put the name back under 9x and justify real size.

## ARMED SENSORS

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(armed provisionally with this deck; session adjudication ratifies)

- price alert: fires below 4050.0 (deck-provisional: 52-week low; a break means the market knows something our filing read does not – freeze adds and re-c)
- dated pack 1904.T-REVIEW|2026-11-13: Taisei Oncho H1 FY27 (~mid-Nov). HIT: H1 OP >55% of ¥3,700M guide (sandbag confirmed -> true ~3x). ALSO track: first M&A deal terms (kill if
- dated pack 1904.T|2026-11-13: 1904.T: H1 FY3/27 tanshin (ESTIMATE from prior-year cadence, NOT company-confirmed): H1 OP >55% of the ¥3,700M guide confirms the sandbag; p
- dated pack 1904.T|2027-02-06: 1904.T: Q3 FY3/27 tanshin (ESTIMATE): if the HQ transfer is still unbooked here, the fiscal-year net income guide is in mechanical jeopardy
- dated pack 1904.T|2027-03-31: 1904.T: FY3/27 fiscal year end – hard deadline for the ~¥4.0bn HQ disposal gain; a slip halves reported net income and re-rates every scree

- dated pack 1904.T|2027-05-13: 1904.T: FY3/27 full-year results and FY3/28 guide (ESTIMATE): recurring EPS >= ¥600 puts the name under 9x and justifies real size (date con

## What remains unverified

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Treated as a work queue, not as footnotes. Ranked by how much each could move the decision.

1. **The rent bill after the headquarters sale.** Unquantified by both benches. Converting an owned building into leased space adds a permanent operating cost that lowers recurring EPS below ¥429. If it is large, 12.0x becomes 13–14x and the starter is a mistake. **Highest-priority open item.**
2. **Whether the ¥1bn staff spend is a single investment year or a new permanent cost base.** Determines whether recurring earnings normalise upward.
3. **The headquarters transfer date.** Disclosed as undecided; management holds the guidance and is moving this autumn, so it expects delivery this fiscal year. Unverifiable until it is announced.
4. **Tax rate applied to the gain.** Red used 32%, blue used 31%; we used blue's. The difference is ~¥40m of net income and ~¥6 of book value per share — immaterial, but the assumption is ours, not the company's.
5. **Backlog margin quality.** Record work in hand is only bullish if it was bid at reasonable margins. The filing discloses the amount, not the profitability. The +152bp gross margin is one quarter of evidence pointing the right way; it is one quarter.
6. **Taisei Oncho USA's project addresses.** Not disclosed. With them, the desk's US permit connectors become usable on the ¥2.84bn/quarter US segment, which currently we can only read at the segment line. This is the specific missing evidence that would turn three “uncheckable” detectors into live ones.
7. **The half-year report date.** 2026-11-13 is inferred from prior-year cadence, not confirmed by the company. Treat the dated pack accordingly.
8. **Average daily volume and free float.** Not pulled. Our sizing constraint is therefore an estimate. Before the second add, verify that the ladder stays under 1% of average daily volume.
9. **Whether the two full-year filings were read directly.** The red bench worked from aggregators and admitted it; the blue bench read the Q1 filing byte-for-byte. The full-year FY3/26 filing has still not been opened directly by either bench.
10. **Any read on the ¥1,031m of goodwill** beyond “legacy, amortising ¥25.6m/quarter.” Not tested for impairment risk.

**Bottom line, stated symmetrically:** the write-up that brought this name to the desk was wrong on every leg it stood on, including one leg — a completed management buyout — that was invented outright. Our own red bench then killed it correctly on the central point and got three subsidiary numbers wrong in the harsh direction while never opening the page that held the bull case. Our own blue bench read the filing properly and found the divergence, but both benches argued about selling a

position we do not own. What is left after all of that is smaller and duller than either the original pitch or the rejection: an unlevered, uncovered Japanese contractor at roughly one times book with a record order book, an expanding gross margin, a covered 3.9% dividend, an unquantified future rent bill, and a one-time property gain that everyone can already see. That earns a minimum starter and a November date. It does not earn size.

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yield on the Y198 dividend and 10.3x recurring EPS of Y429 -- add to  
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year end -- hard deadline for the ~Y4.0bn HQ disposal gain; a slip  
halves reported net income and re-rates every screener PER from 6x  
to 12x", "confirmed": true}, {"date": "2027-05-13", "what": "FY3/27  
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puts the name under 9x and justifies real size", "confirmed":  
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recurring EPS of Y429, record Y56.8bn backlog covering 89% of the  
revenue guide, gross margin +152bp, 3.86% covered dividend -- bought  
as carry with a small filing-read edge, sized down because the post-  
sale rent expense is unquantified"}}
```